Lankan government in the early 1980s. Prabhakaran had been well trained by the R&AW at undisclosed locations in Uttar Pradesh. When Kosala became one of the most prized assets of the Indian spy agency in 2002, Prabhakaran's era was drifting into darkness. But Kosala had warned Avinash that Prabhakaran was not pleased with the peace negotiations, believing the Tigers had been given a raw deal. He predicted that the LTTE would be back with yet another long, bloody battle within a few years. It was a prophetic statement and the only reason Avinash was back in the Sri Lankan capital.

'LTTE is not very comfortable with President Mahinda Rajapaksa. I should rather say Prabhakaran doesn't trust the president and the president doesn't want Prabhakaran to live even for a minute on Sri Lankan soil. They hate each other and the peace talks in Norway will ultimately fail. Prabhakaran will never join talks with the Rajapaksa government,' Kosala said calmly over a cup of coffee.

Avinash laughed. 'So do you think an all out war is the only option?' he asked.

'The president thinks so. Though he may give the LTTE another chance under pressure from the international community,' Kosala smiled.

Months later, war had returned. Kosala was the first to inform Avinash about an attack in April 2006 targeting the Sri Lankan army chief Sarath Fonseka. The LTTE denied the suicide attack which had badly injured the army chief, but President Rajapaksa squarely blamed the Tigers for the act of terror and the air force was ordered to carry out intense strikes against the LTTE's strongholds. The strikes lasted for two days. But more was to come. Avinash and Kosala watched the LTTE mount yet